

EAST AFRICAN SAND BOA

Gongylophis colubrinus

This African snake, with a stout body and short tail, waits in a burrow with only its head exposed to catch unsuspecting prey.



90 cm
35 in

small, smooth scales
assist in burrowing

mottled brown
coloration for
camouflage

1.1 m
3½ ft

head with
small eyes

head-like tail
used in defence

CALABAR GROUND BOA

Calabaria reinhardtii

Native to W. Africa, the Calabar ground boa hunts in burrows for small mammals. It is the only egg-laying boa.



RAINBOW BOA

Epicrates cenchria

Microscopic ridges on the scales of this S. American snake refract light to give it an iridescent sheen. It hunts for mammals in forests.



2 m
6½ ft

long,
muscular body

smooth, glossy scales

1 m
3¼ ft

NEW GUINEA GROUND BOA

Candoia aspera

A sharply angled snout helps to identify this New Guinea snake. It is a slow-moving terrestrial hunter of small vertebrates.



10 m
33 ft

RUBBER BOA

Charina bottae

Preferring cool, humid conditions, this burrowing species is found at high altitudes and as far north as British Columbia.

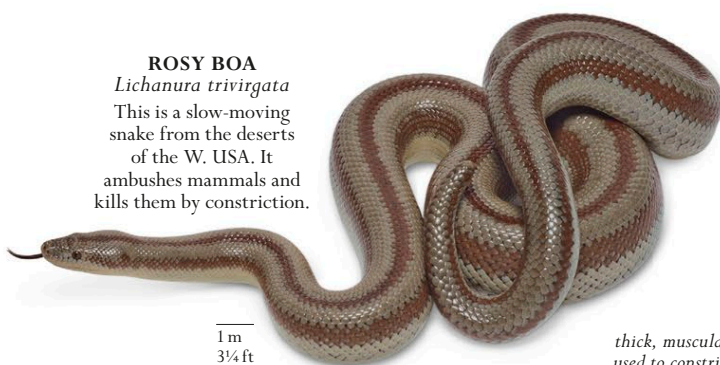


80 cm
32 in

ROSY BOA

Lichanura trivirgata

This is a slow-moving snake from the deserts of the W. USA. It ambushes mammals and kills them by constriction.



1 m
3¼ ft

thick, muscular body
used to constrict prey

dull yellow colour
with prominent
black spots

GREEN ANACONDA

Eunectes murinus

This aquatic S. American species is the largest of the New World snakes. It hides in water and kills its prey by constriction.

